

Strategies for Individualizing Community Based Day Supports



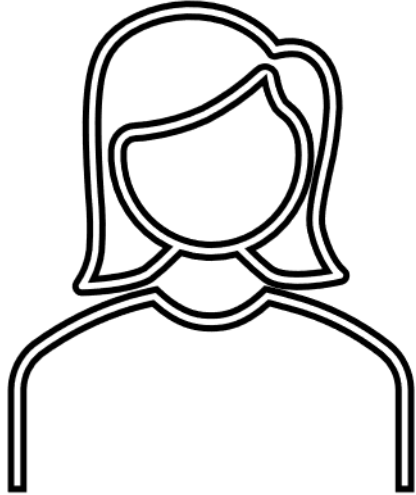
Institute for Community Inclusion at UMass Boston, in partnership with the
Massachusetts Department of Developmental Services.

Copyright and Intellectual Property Reminder

- This webinar, including all content, presentations, materials, and information shared, is the exclusive property of the Institute for Community Inclusion (ICI) at UMass Boston and is protected by copyright and other intellectual property laws.
- **Use of AI prohibited:** The use of AI bots, automated note-taking tools, or any other AI-based recording or transcription technologies is prohibited in accordance with the University's AI use policies.
- **No Recording or Reproduction:** Attendees may not record, screenshot, stream, scrape, download, or otherwise capture, reproduce, distribute, or use any part of this webinar without the express written permission of ICI.
- **No Commercial Use:** Content may not be used for commercial purposes, training materials, or any derivative works.
- **Violations:** Unauthorized use may result in legal action, including DMCA takedown notices and claims for damages.



Instructor



Beth Wike, M.A.

Training Associate

Institute for Community Inclusion

Elizabeth.Wike@umb.edu



EMPLOYMENT FIRST MASSACHUSETTS

Institute for Community Inclusion at UMass Boston, with support from the Massachusetts Department of Developmental Services



Guidelines for Today's Training



Please keep your camera on, if possible.



CC is available via Zoom.



Questions, discussions,
responses:
use audio or chat



Attendance checks
throughout the training.

Today's Agenda

- CBDS at a Glance
 - Scope of services
- Person-Centered Thinking and Planning
 - Choice
 - Important To vs Important For
 - Individualized Outcomes
- Strategies:
 - Discovery and Exploration
 - Community Mapping
 - Building calendars and schedules
- Wrap-up and Resources



CBDS Defined

“This program of supports is designed to enable an individual to enrich his or her life and enjoy a full range of community activities by providing opportunities for developing, enhancing, and maintaining competency in personal, social and community activities” (MA DDS)

- Career Exploration
- Volunteering
- Skills Training and Development
- Socialization
- Pursuit of Personal Hobbies and Interests



Building Strong CBDS Programs

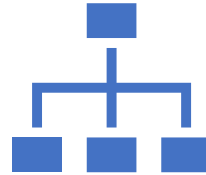


Person Centered Practices and Community Based Day Supports



Person-Centered Thinking:

Deep respect for individuals and their equality



Person-Centered Planning:

Process and approach for determining-planning-working towards

Core Values

- **Choice**
- Dignity
- Respect
- Strength Based
- Whole person



EMPLOYMENT FIRST MASSACHUSETTS

Institute for Community Inclusion at UMass Boston, with support from the Massachusetts Department of Developmental Services



Supporting Choice

Everyone has
preferences, likes
and dislikes

People need to be
engaged in
discovery and
exploration

Consider: What is
available vs what
is possible

Quantity vs
Quality of Choice

Good vs Bad
Choices



EMPLOYMENT FIRST MASSACHUSETTS

Institute for Community Inclusion at UMass Boston, with support from the Massachusetts Department of Developmental Services



Important
TO

Important
FOR



EMPLOYMENT FIRST MASSACHUSETTS

Institute for Community Inclusion at UMass Boston, with support from the Massachusetts Department of Developmental Services



Individual Outcomes

- What an individual hopes to GAIN from services
- Describes what you hope to achieve
- The ultimate results, impact of services
- Reflects and aligns with *Important TO*

Example:

Chris will increase his social skills.

-or-

Chris will join community comic book club in order to connect with peers and increase social skills.



Discovery & Exploration

What we need to know

- Important *to* and *for*
- Who are the important people?
- Skills and abilities
- Strengths
- Interests, likes, dislikes
- Idea of a great/bad day
- Vision for a good life



Discovery & Exploration

Methods

- Interviews & Conversations
- Observations
- Tools and Assessments
- Trial and error of various activities
- File review

Factors to Consider

- Maximize time in the community
- Use a variety of methods
- Spend time in different environments
- Prioritize the voice of the individual
- Gather various perspectives
- Document



Tools for Discovery & Person-Centered Planning

Positive Personal Profile

TransCen, Inc.
Positive Personal Profile



Details	
Dreams and Goals:	Interests:
Talents, Skills and Knowledge:	Learning Styles:
Values:	Positive Personality Traits:
Environmental Preferences:	Dislikes:
Work Experiences:	Support System:
Specific Challenges:	Solutions and Accommodations:
Career Ideas, Community Connections and Possibilities to Explore:	

For more information contact us at inquiries@transcen.org or TransCen.org

Charting the LifeCourse

Past Life Experiences
List past life experiences and events that have supported your goals. What is your story?

Moving Forward
List current or future life experiences or goals that will contribute to your support plan. What is your story?

Vision for What I Want
List what you want your "IDEAL LIFE" to look like.

What I Don't Want
List the things you don't want or what is NOT a "good life".

Download the Charting the LifeCourse tool - InstituteForCommunityInclusion.org
It is available in the directory of InstituteForCommunityInclusion.org - InstituteForCommunityInclusion.org



EMPLOYMENT FIRST MASSACHUSETTS

Institute for Community Inclusion at UMass Boston, with support from the Massachusetts Department of Developmental Services



Community Mapping



Who is Mapping?

What are we Mapping?

What do we do with this information?

How do we gather the information?

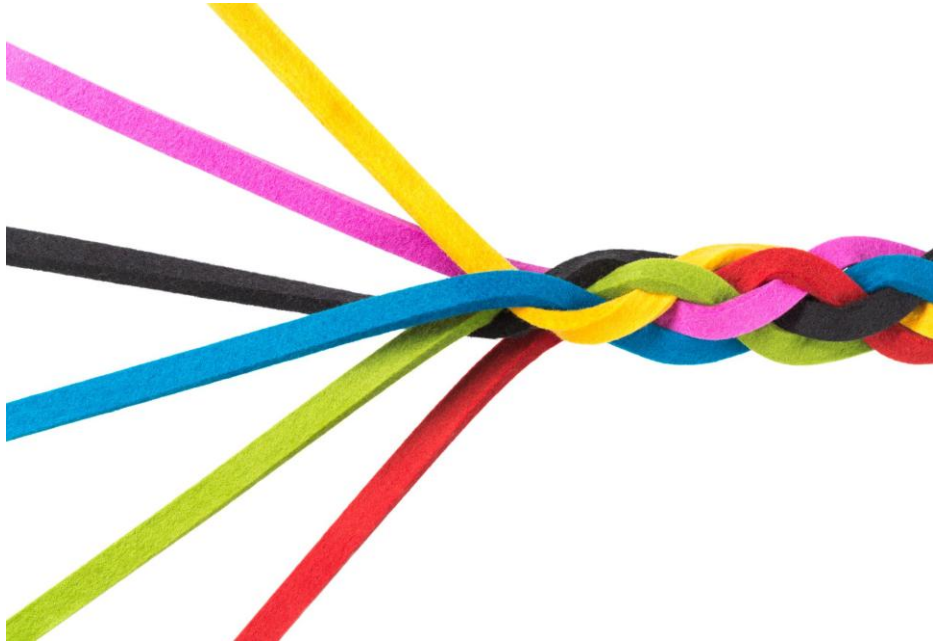


EMPLOYMENT FIRST MASSACHUSETTS

Institute for Community Inclusion at UMass Boston, with support from the Massachusetts Department of Developmental Services



Scheduling for Success



Start small

- Add in individualized opportunities
- Starfire example: Breaking out approach

Intentional grouping

- Small groups with identified shared interests
- Staff alignment

Tap into staff talents & interests

Integrating systems for choice

- Create ways to collect feedback
- Activity diversity



Individualizing Supports: Program vs Person-Centered

Services that support a Program Life	Services that support Community Membership
Dwayne goes on a group outing from the day program to listen to the local orchestra	Dwayne is supported to become a volunteer at a local summer concert series or volunteer with the local high school or community college band.
Staff help Dwayne download his favorite music	Staff help Dwayne build a YouTube channel with his favorite music and he builds a social media following
Dwayne gets to choose the music in the van on Mondays	Dwayne is supported in getting a job at a music store
Dwayne gets music therapy at the program center	Dwayne takes lessons at the local music store
Dwayne is a member of the music club at the center	Dwayne hangs out, on a regular basis, at places that support the local music scene



Key takeaways:

- Individualizing supports requires person-centered thinking and planning
- Consider: What is important to this individual, and how is the program going to support them moving forward?
- Discovery and exploration set the foundation for individualized and person-centered practices
- Create a system for capturing observations, feedback, and use as a living document
- No need for an overhaul. Start small. Trial and error. Be open to learning and growing.



Resources

- [Community Life Engagement Toolkit](#)
 - 4-Guideposts
 - Agency Fidelity Scale
- [Charting the LifeCourse](#)
 - Video tutorials, tools, templates, guides
 - [Daily Life and Employment Resources](#)
 - [Integrated Support Star for Community Mapping](#)
- [Positive Personal Profile](#)
 - [TransCen Resources](#)
- EmploymentFirstMA
- [Starfire Transformation Story](#)



Michael Smull & Support Development Associates

- [Support Development Associates](#)
- [SDA Resources](#)
- [Michael Smull Person Centered Thinking and Planning- Videos](#)
- [Michael Smull Discovery Methods - Videos](#)

Relationship map

Rituals and routines

Top tips or 2-minute drill

Good day/bad day

What is working /not working

The 4+1 questions

The learning log

